CHAPTER 8 · TIME SIGNATURES

Lesson Book draft v1 + review pack

The first room of Level 2, in path order (Book rule 11). It keeps to the level plan's scope for room 8: **bar lines, the double bar line and the repeat sign; 2/4, 3/4 and 4/4; strong and weak beats; filling a bar; rests on the staff; a tie across the bar line**. 6/8 and cut time wait for the drill's higher levels, with Book rule 13's 2/8, 4/8, 4/2, 6/4, 9/4, 12/4 and 5/8, 7/8, 7/4.

It builds on chapter 5 (the note values and their rests, a heart for each beat, held beats lighter, a rest's beat in a dashed circle, 1 + 2 +) and chapter 6 (the treble clef, G on line 2). This is the first book that writes rhythms on the staff. Every note sits on G, line 2 of the treble clef, so reading a pitch never gets in the way (B3).

AMEB: the level plan puts 2/4, 3/4 and bar lines at Preliminary, and 4/4 and 6/8 at Grade 1.

The draft, 7 pages: 1 two bars of 4/4 (opener) · 2 Bars and bar lines, and the repeat sign · 3 The two numbers (2/4, 3/4, 4/4 and C) · 4 Strong and weak beats · 5 Fill the bar, and rests on the staff · 6 The tie · 7 My five checks.

How to answer: reply with codes, e.g. "B2 yes, B5 stamp, G3 none". Or "all as recommended". The yellow marks in the draft show the lines that wait for your answers.

Three questions for the public guide page

G1	When your students meet time signatures and bars, what goes wrong most often? (My guesses: counting on past the top number instead of back to 1; rushing the last beat of a bar; letting go of a tied note; playing the repeat only once.)
G2	Anything you always say or do for bars and the strong beat (conducting, a march and a waltz, patting the 1) that the page should catch?
G3	A tip for parents, or none, as for chapters 3 and 11?

What's in this pack

A · what today's chapter 8 does · B · your decisions, each with my recommendation · the 7 draft pages · today's online lesson and Workbook, for comparison.

A · What today's chapter 8 does

Today chapter 8 is an online lesson in thirteen steps, a drill with 5 levels, and a Workbook and Teacher copy made before the Book rules. There is no Lesson Book yet.

A1 The online lesson, thirteen steps: the two numbers (simple and compound), common time and cut time, bar lines, the bottom number changes the beat, compound time, grouping notes, duplets and triplets, then what moved in from chapters 3 and 5: strong and weak beats, tap the right beat, writing rests correctly, fix the bar, fill the bar, which bar did you hear?

A2 It teaches more than room 8: 6/8, 9/8 and 12/8; 2/2 and 3/2; the bottom number 8 and 2; grouping quavers; duplets and triplets.

A3 The drill's 5 levels: what do the numbers mean; which time signature fits the bar; listen: 2, 3 or 4 beats; in 8 time, how many beats; simple or compound.

A4 The Workbook and Teacher copy came before the Book rules: a bar as a lunch box, a chapter map, and pages on compound time and quaver counting.

A5 Several tools still count **1 & 2 &**. Your rule 12 writes it **1 + 2 +**; they change when this chapter is applied.

A6 Korean: the app calls the thin-thick end line 겹세로줄, which is two thin lines. The draft says **끝세로줄** (B7).

Checked by a second reviewer

A separate reviewer checked every page in English and Korean. Every bar adds up to its top number; the bar lines, the double bar line and the repeat sign are right; the rests sit where they should; the counts are right (held beats lighter, rests dashed, the beat after a tie lighter). I applied these fixes from its list:

- The dotted minim's dot sits in the space above G, not on the line; the tie starts and ends just under the noteheads.
- The semibreve rest is centred in its bar; the labels sit over what they name and are no longer cut off.
- Page 3 shows the C for common time, not only the words.
- Every piano task names the hand, the finger and the key: right hand, finger 3, G.
- One fact a sentence on page 5; "Its other name is a measure."; the real name "double bar line" (끝세로줄) on page 1 and in the checks.
- 4/4: strong, weak, medium, weak (B4); pat the 1 and clap the rest, as the toolbox's "Strong and weak beats" does (B5).
- Korean: 도돌이표예요. 처음으로 돌아가서; 조금 더 세게 쳐요; 붙임줄: 한 번 치고, 두 음표만큼 누르고 있어요.

B · Your decisions

B1 Today's extras move out: grouping quavers, duplets and triplets to Rhythm Patterns (chapter 14); compound time (6/8 and more), cut time and the bottom number to the drill's higher levels, each marked with its grade. **Rec** yes.

B2 Common time: page 3 shows **C** beside 4/4, "Its other name is common time." Or leave C for later. **Rec** yes, now.

B3 Rhythms on the staff, every note on G (line 2 of the treble clef), played with right hand finger 3. Or on middle C, or on a one-line rhythm staff. **Rec** G.

B4 4/4: strong, weak, **medium**, weak (big, small, middle, small hearts). Or only "beat 1 is strong". **Rec** medium.

B5 The body: pat your knees on 1 and clap on the other beats, counting out loud. Or stamp on 1. **Rec** pat.

B6 The semibreve rest as a whole bar of silence: in this book only in 4/4. In 2/4 and 3/4 (AMEB Theory Grade 2) it waits for a higher drill level. **Rec** yes.

B7 Korean for the thin-thick end line: **끝세로줄**, in the book and the app (today 겹세로줄). **Rec** yes.

B8 The repeat sign: only the end repeat (go back to the start). The facing start repeat and first and second endings come later. **Rec** yes.

B9 The tie only (same line or space). The slur, the sign for legato, comes with Loud & Soft (chapter 10). **Rec** yes.

B10 The drill, 6 levels for this room: 1 how many beats in a bar (the top number) · 2 where does the bar line go? · 3 tap the strong beat (on the click, scored like chapter 3) · 4 fill the bar (the one note or rest that fits) · 5 rests on the staff (which rest, on which line) · 6 ties: how many beats? Higher levels with their grade: 6/8 and 2/2, then rule 13's time signatures. **Rec** yes.

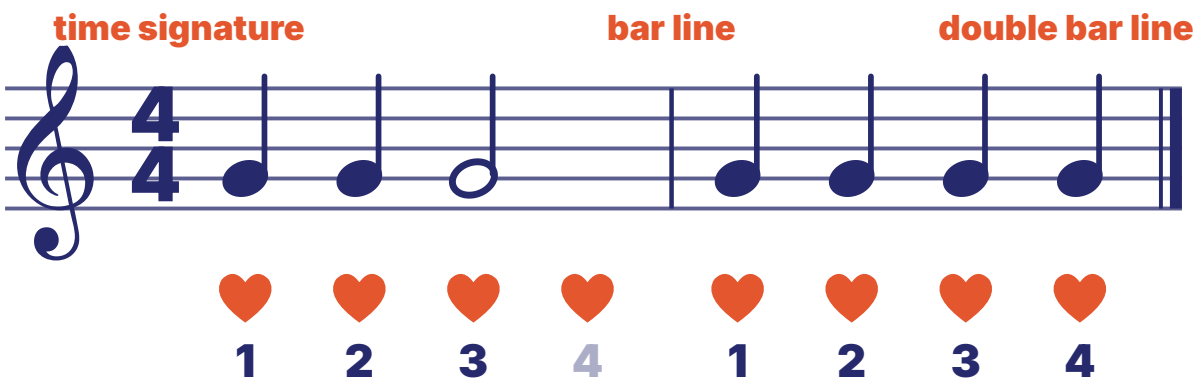
B11 Workbook (after the book), set tasks a child does alone: W1 draw the bar lines · W2 write the time signature · W3 mark the strong beats · W4 fill the bar · W5 ties: write the count, held beats in grey boxes · last page: the check-up on paper. **Rec** all six.

B12 On screen (the book, with what moves): tap the strong beat with the click; build a bar until it is full; hear a tie, then the same bar without it. **Rec** yes.

CHAPTER 8

Time Signatures

Music is cut into **bars**. The **time signature** at the start says how many beats each bar holds.



In this chapter

- [ ] Bars and bar lines 2
- [ ] The two numbers 3
- [ ] Strong and weak beats 4
- [ ] Fill the bar 5
- [ ] The tie 6
- [ ] My five checks 7

By the end, you can

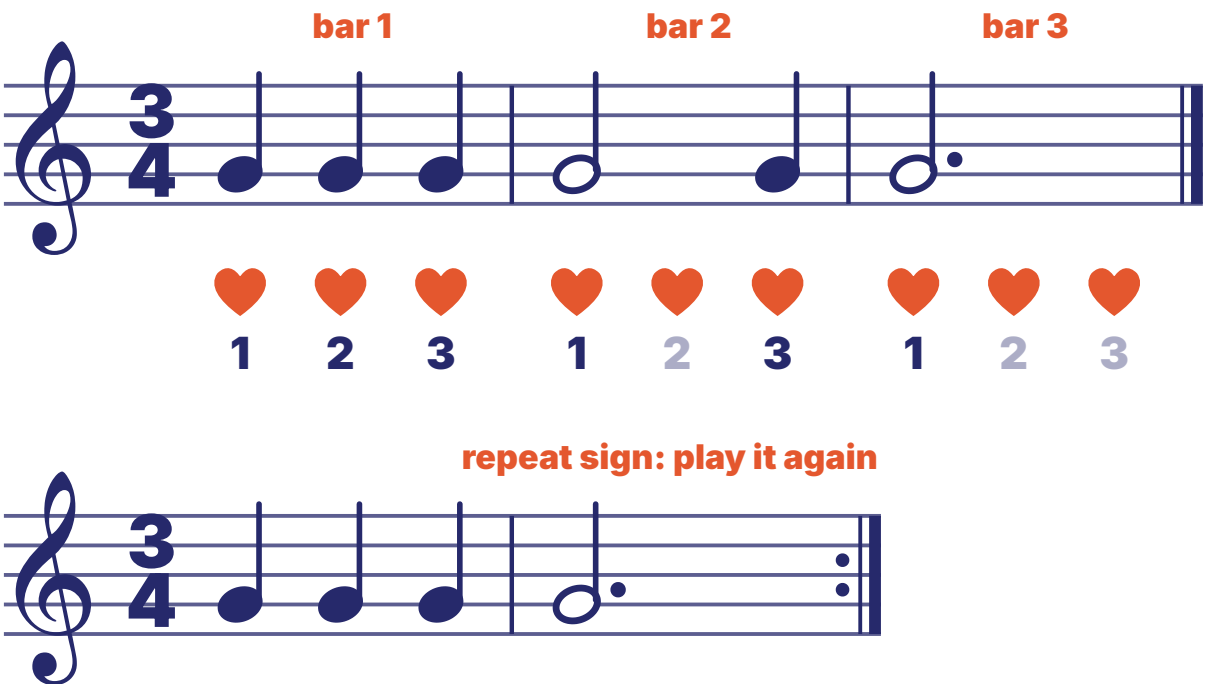
- [ ] show the bar lines, the double bar line and the repeat sign
- [ ] read the top number and count each bar
- [ ] play beat 1 a little stronger
- [ ] count the notes and rests in a bar
- [ ] play a tie: once, then hold

online

STEP 1

Bars and bar lines

A **bar line** cuts the music into **bars**. Each bar holds the same number of beats. Its other name is a measure. A **double bar line** is the end. With two dots before it, it is a **repeat sign**: go back to the start and play it again.



At the piano

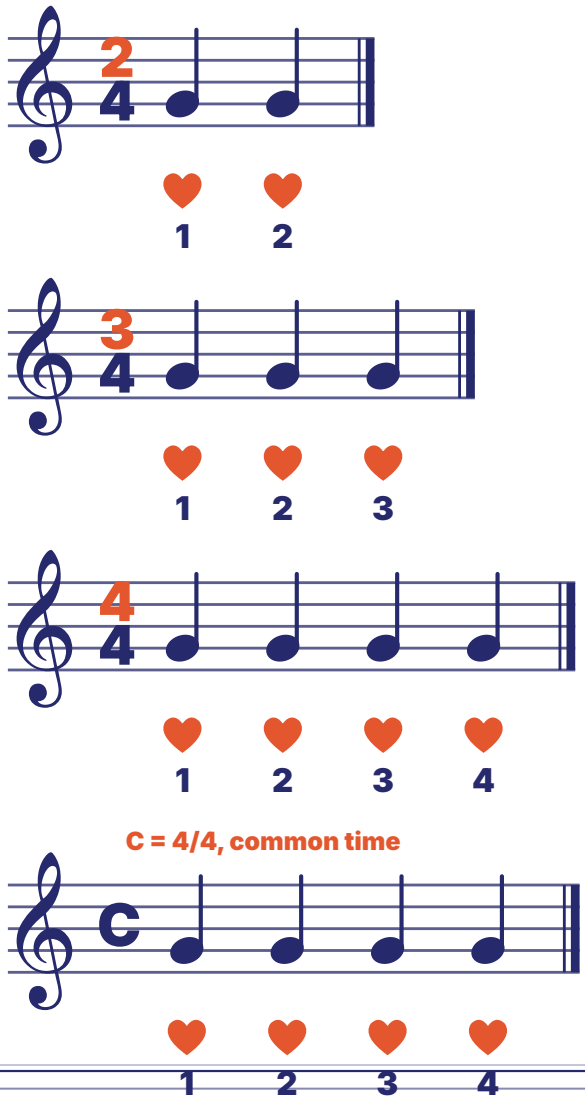
1. Right hand, finger 3 on G: play the three bars, counting 1 2 3 in each bar. ☐
2. Right hand, finger 3 on G: play the two bars with the repeat sign, counting 1 2 3. Go back and play them again. Four bars in all. ☐

REMEMBER **Bar lines make bars. Two dots: play it again.**

STEP 2

The two numbers

A **time signature** has two numbers. The **top number**: how many beats in each bar. The **bottom number** 4: each beat is a crotchet. 4/4 can also be written **C**. B2 Its other name is common time.



At the piano

1. Right hand, finger 3 on G: four bars of 2/4, four of 3/4, four of 4/4. Count out loud: 1 2, 1 2 3, 1 2 3 4. ☐
2. Your teacher shows a time signature card. Pat your knees up to the top number, then back to 1. Two bars each. ☐

REMEMBER **Top: beats in a bar. Bottom 4: a crotchet beat.**

STEP 3
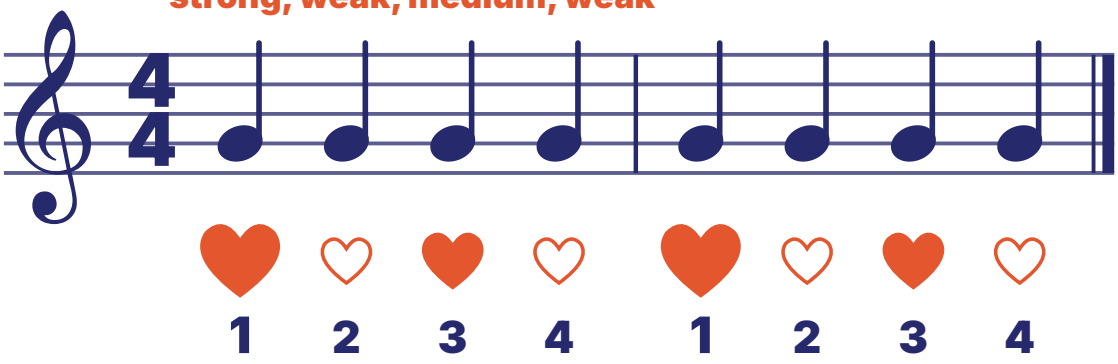
Strong and weak beats

Beat **1** of every bar is the **strong beat**. Play it a little louder: **1** 2 3. [B4] In 4/4, beat 3 is a medium beat.

strong, weak, weak



strong, weak, medium, weak



At the piano

1 [B5] Pat your knees on 1 and clap on the other beats. Count out loud. Four bars each of 2/4, 3/4 and 4/4. ☐

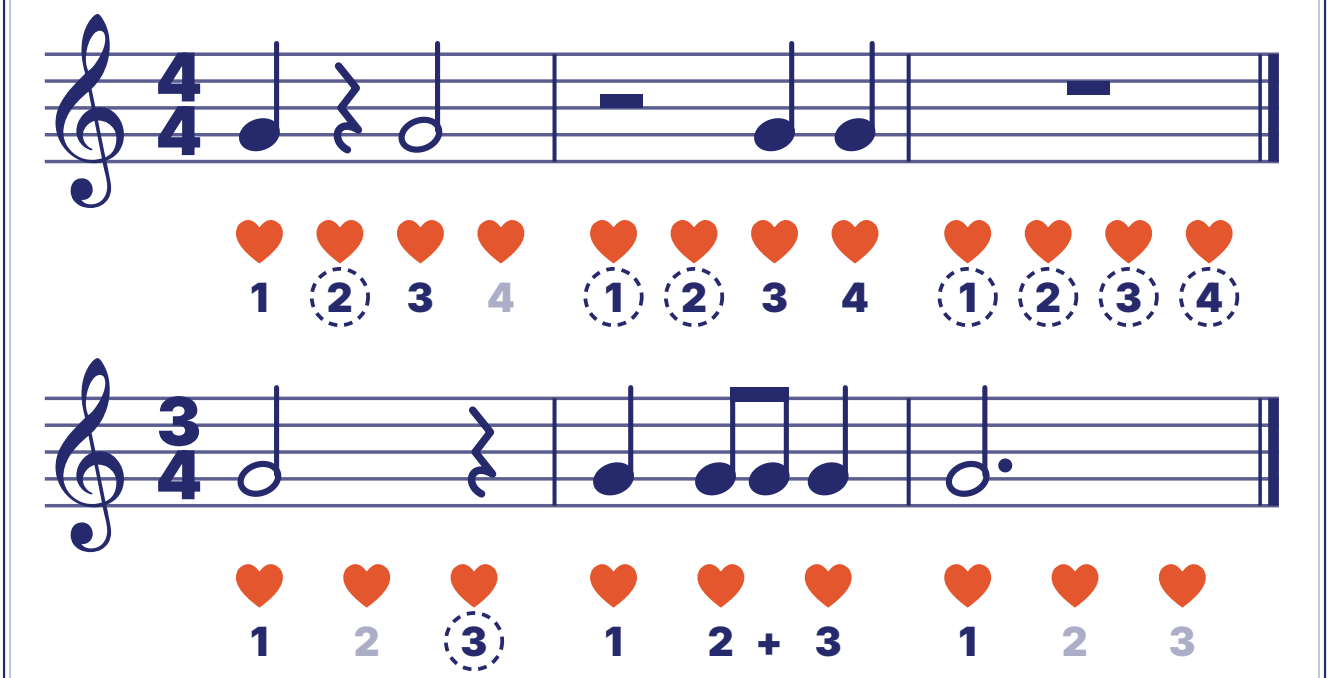
2 Right hand, finger 3 on G: a crotchet on every beat, beat 1 a little louder. Four bars of 3/4, then four of 4/4. ☐

REMEMBER **Beat 1 is strong.**

STEP 4

Fill the bar

In every bar, the notes and rests add up to the **top number**. The crotchet rest stands in the **middle** of the staff. The minim rest **sits on line 3**. The semibreve rest **hangs from line 4**. [B6] In 4/4, a semibreve rest is a whole bar of silence.



At the piano

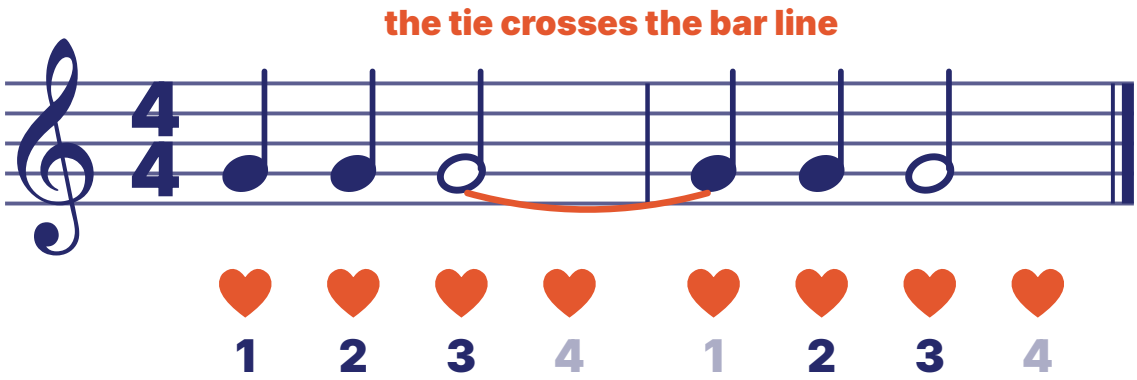
1. Right hand, finger 3 on G: play the three bars of 4/4. In the rests, lift your hand just above the key and keep counting. ☐
2. Right hand, finger 3 on G: play the three bars of 3/4 and count out loud. Two quavers are 2 +. ☐

REMEMBER **Notes and rests fill each bar exactly.**

STEP 5

The tie

A **tie** joins two notes on the same line or space. Play the first, then hold it through the second. A tie can cross a bar line.



At the piano

1. Right hand, finger 3 on G: play the two bars. Hold the minim through beat 1 of bar 2, and count the light numbers out loud too. ☐
2. Right hand, finger 3 on G: play the two bars again without the tie. Play G again on beat 1 of bar 2. Hear the difference. ☐

REMEMBER **A tie: play once, hold for both.**

CHECK-UP

My five checks

Show each one at the piano. Colour a circle: not yet, nearly, or got it! The check-up on paper is in the Workbook.

At the piano

	NOT YET	NEARLY	GOT IT!
 **I can show the bar lines, the double bar line and the repeat sign**	○	◑	☆
 **I can read the top number and count each bar**	○	◑	☆
 **I can play beat 1 a little stronger**	○	◑	☆
 **I can count the notes and rests in a bar**	○	◑	☆
 **I can play a tie: once, then hold**	○	◑	☆

Colour a circle each time it gets better: not yet, then nearly, then got it!

Today's online lesson and Workbook, for comparison

The thirteen steps today start with the two numbers, simple and compound. Below: the top of the lesson on screen, and two of today's Workbook pages.



